further emphasized that the Tatas were in business for the long term. He said, ‘We buy companies, we do not sell them.’

He entrusted the task of reiterating Tata’s reassurance to the workforce to Kant. ‘Kant made two visits to the UK to assure the union that there would be no attempt to “Indianize” the companies and that Tata would continue to receive Ford engines and other parts for some time,’ wrote *The Wall Street Journal*.

Besides the companies’ 16,000-strong workforce, the labour unions were also concerned about safeguarding the ‘40,000 jobs’ ‘mainly in the supplier industry’ connected with JLR. Kant allayed any fears that they may have harboured about losing their jobs. He pledged that should the group win the bid, it would not ‘export UK-based jobs to lower cost factories in India’. He also assured them that Tata Motors was willing to ‘assume full responsibility of the Jaguar and Land Rover pension schemes’ and that both would continue to remain ‘iconic British brands’. Elaborating later, Kant says that because of their brand value, it made pragmatic sense not to alter their identity. ‘Its brand loyalty was fierce,’ he recalls. In this context, Ratan also told the *Los Angeles Times*, ‘We believe it is the duty of whoever owns them to nurture the image, to retain their touch and feel … They are British brands—and they should remain British.’

One rumour that especially agitated the workforce was that the acquisition was a ‘real estate proposition’ and ‘everybody would be out of a job’. Faced with this situation, Ratan once again stepped in directly. He held ‘three or four town-hall meetings with the employees’ where he killed the speculations, directly answering the questions that the workers had. He personally assured them that the Tatas would see them as partners and ‘work shoulder-to-shoulder’ to bring back Jaguar and Land Rover to its glory days. He stated in an interview to *The Times*, ‘We do not create a trauma within the company we take over.’

The meetings held by Kant and Ratan had a salutary effect on the workforce. The trade unions responded by supporting the Tatas’ bid. On 22 November 2007, Unite, Britain’s largest trade union in the auto sector, issued a statement in favour of the Tatas. Tony Woodley, its joint general secretary, said: ‘… the best interests of the workforce would be served by finding a partner with an established presence and background in manufacturing … The stewards agreed that the Tatas best fit these criteria.’ The union representatives further added that Tata Motors was ‘“the only